

University of Michigan

Jared Harmon
1233 Stacy Dr.
Canton, MI 48188
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To whom it may concern,

I am writing in response to your job posting for an Applications Programmer Associate at the University of Michigan. I was referred to this position by Leslie Bell, a member of the LSA team at the University of Michigan. After reading the job description, I feel I have a skillset that is well suited to the position, including Linux system management, compliance and security procedures, Python backend development (including with legacy code and updating), and frontend development that gives me a range of full stack engineering experience. I feel that the opportunities and collaboration present in this position are too exciting to pass up, and I hope I can provide unique insight and experience to the team and those we would be working with.

While my overall IT experience has a broader range, including network administration and technical support, I would like to focus on my experience as a developer with Barracuda Networks and at home on multiple private projects. At Barracuda Networks, I joined the engineering team from the Archiver compliance products at a time when it was a very small team with a very high workload -- this unfortunately meant that from the beginning I was on my own, and I had to teach myself what I needed to know right away in order to be able to sufficiently help with several ongoing emergencies and ongoing projects (updating the tech stack for an eventual migration to cloud services). I ended up solely taking over a web application project that allowed our support team to troubleshoot issues on our own cloud service for customers, which had not been updated in 5+ years prior to me taking ownership of it. While I was officially moved to the Front End team, this provided me with a full stack development responsibility as I needed to both ensure backend processes provided correct and timely information as well as ensuring that the support team not only had access, but limited access depending on their role.

Privately, I am currently assisting in maintaining and updating a personal website / project for an artist friend who has no development experience of their own. This currently involves containerizing the project to allow others to assist with development more readily, migrating the site to a new more stable host, and updating the web framework from version 2 to version 3. Additionally, I am working with a pre-investment startup to help build a social media site, which currently involves several of the same processes in containerizing the project, hosting the site, and researching and designing a roadmap for future scaling.

I hope this shows that I am not only willing to learn if offered this position, but actively look forward to it. My experience to date has required me to constantly adapt to new and unfamiliar situations, and I get great enjoyment out of collaborating with and helping others.

I eagerly look forward to the next step of the application process; until then, please feel free to reach me any time by phone at 248-921-3428 or by email at mr.jared.harmon@gmail.com.

Sincerely,
Jared Harmon

Jared Harmon

248.921.3428 mr.jared.harmon@gmail.com

Skills

- **Proficient In:** Python
- **Experience With:** Flask, C++, Perl, Java, JavaScript, React, CSS, HTML, PHP
- **Tools:** Bash, Docker, Git, Jenkins, Jira, Linux, Puppet
- **Databases:** Cassandra, Elasticsearch, MySQL, Postgres, Redis

Work Experience

Barracuda Networks August 16, 2021 – August 13, 2024 *Associate Software Engineer*

- Developed software improvements in Python to integrate a distributed service with Microsoft EWS API, improved exception handling, and added concurrent processing
- Led development of internal lookup tool for Support staff to access diagnostic customer information for an email archiving service in several regions worldwide
- Fully documented lookup tool development practices, build process, basic and common troubleshooting steps, entire code architecture, and roadmap for next 12 months
- Reduced lookup tool load time from ~2.5 minutes to 1 second average
- Manually reprocessed ~500TB of initially failed customer data
- Assisting with full product UI update to React

Barracuda Networks June 19, 2017 – August 16, 2021 *Technical Support Representative (Tier 2C)*

- Team lead, Escalations Lead, Premium Support
- Sole point of contact for product escalations; reduced developer escalations by 50%
- Provided specialized support to enterprise customers and government contracts, including air-gapped devices
- Lead team training regarding customer service, internal tools, bug fixes, feature updates, troubleshooting procedures, and approved solutions.
- Documented new processes/bugs and relayed information between development, management, sales, and support teams.

Busch's Fresh Food Market September 15, 2015 – June 19, 2017 *Junior Network Administrator*

- Communicated with vendors to manage hardware inventory on projects and purchase orders
- Installed and updated all network hardware for 17 locations, including the opening of two new locations
- Led project to update employee inventory hardware, including testing current hardware, researching available new hardware and generating network heatmaps at all locations

Education

Washtenaw Community College

- Associate in Science for Computer Science: Programming in Java
- Completed August 4, 2014